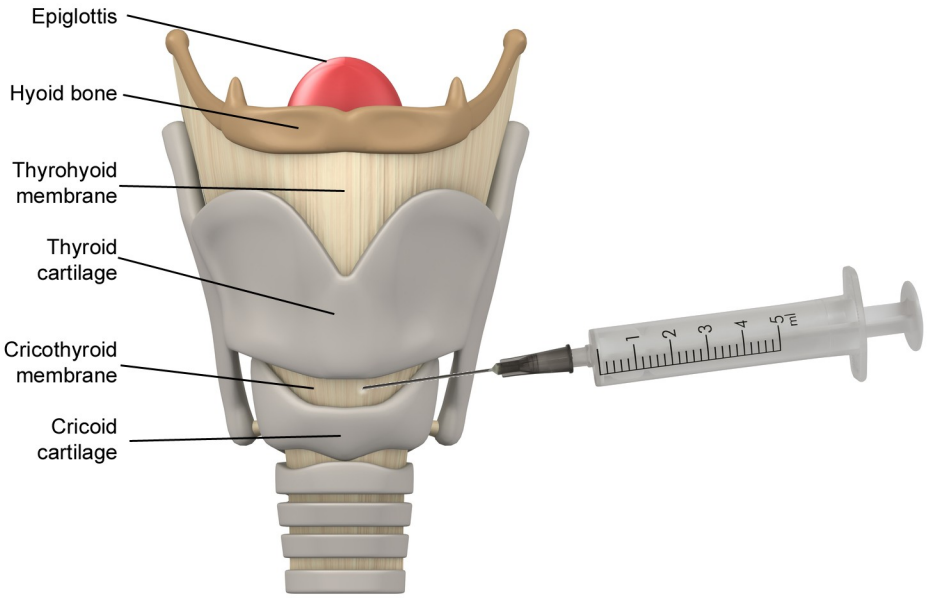
A transtracheal block is an effective method of anesthetizing the airway for awake airway procedures. It is performed by injecting 5 mL of 2% lidocaine (alternatively, 4ml of 4% lidocaine) through the cricothyroid membrane using a 23-gauge needle or 24-gauge angiocatheter. Aspiration should be performed continually while the needle is directed caudally. When air bubbles are seen in the syringe, the tip of the needle is in the trachea. On deep inspiration, the local anesthetic should be injected into the trachea. The patient will cough, which will spread the local anesthetic throughout the trachea.



Nagelhout JJ, Plaus K. Nurse Anesthesia. 5th ed. St. Louis, MO: Elsevier Saunders Company; 2014: 448.

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